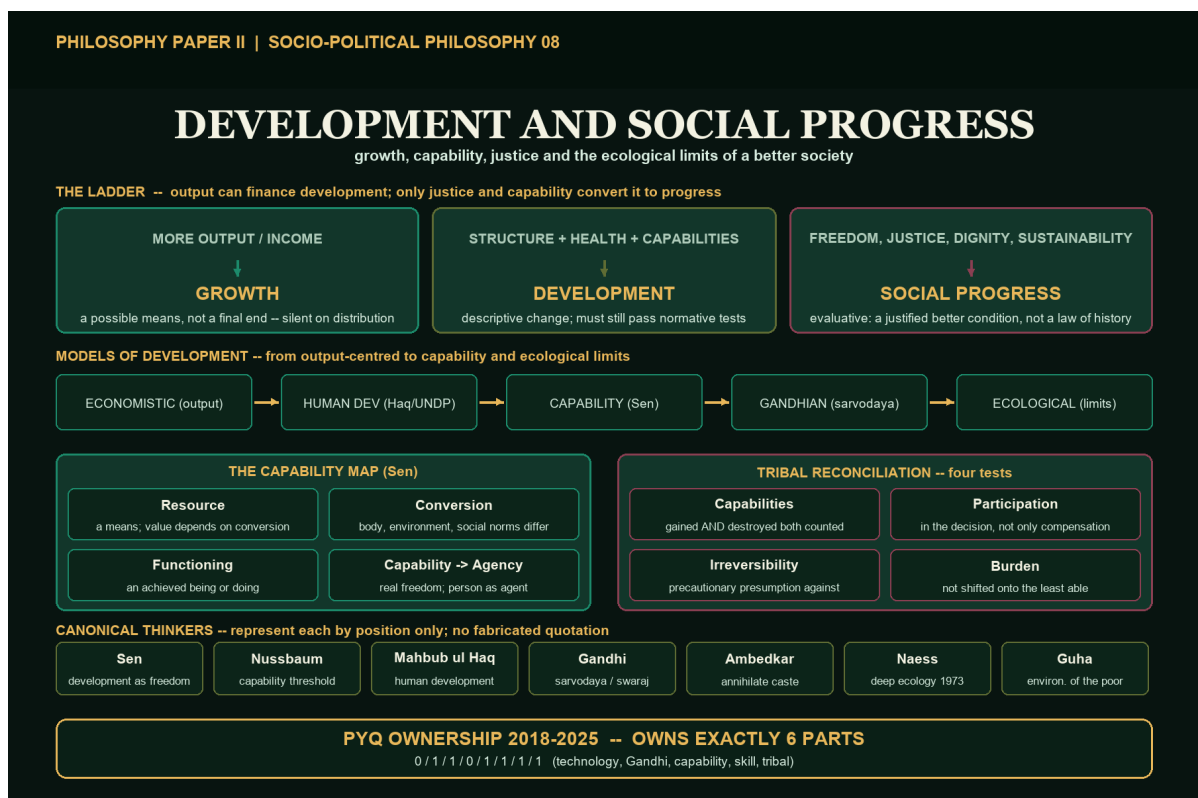


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

DEVELOPMENT AND SOCIAL PROGRESS - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Socio-Political Philosophy 08

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

DEVELOPMENT AND SOCIAL PROGRESS - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Socio-Political Philosophy 08

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 6 owner questions (2018:0, 2019:1, 2020:1, 2021:0, 2022:1, 2023:1, 2024:1, 2025:1).
- Ownership discipline: caste-and-village stems (Caste Discrimination), gender-as-capability stems (Gender Discrimination), abstract justice/equality/liberty framing (Social and Political Ideals), ideology-label stems (Political Ideologies), universal-dignity and plurality stems (Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism) and environmental policy/data (Environment and Governance areas) are kept separate and not double-owned here.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: thesis -> doctrine in canonical terms -> named evidence unit (D1-D15) or Indian legal example -> objection/reply/residual -> graded verdict, each closing with a "Why this earns marks" note.
- MCQs: 40 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 48, strict A-B-C-D rotation 12 times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Provenance discipline observed throughout: Sen, Nussbaum, Mahbub ul Haq/UNDP, Gandhi, Ambedkar, Naess (1973), the Brundtland Report (1987, paraphrased) and Guha and Martinez-Alier (1997) by position and standard title only; the PESA Act 1996 and the Forest Rights Act 2006 as enacted statutes, Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013) as a Supreme Court judgment, and Articles 48A and 51A(g) as non-justiciable constitutional provisions - dated facts, not philosophical proof; no environmental datum, target, project or region named.
- No current-affairs anchor is used (no verified 2026 development forced); relevance is static and syllabus-driven.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is the 6 exact verified PYQs -> 40 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED EVIDENCE (D1-D15) / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION / REPLY / RESIDUAL -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 6 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 6 primary parts (2018:0, 2019:1, 2020:1, 2021:0, 2022:1, 2023:1, 2024:1, 2025:1). Ownership discipline (explained, not silently double-owned): caste-and-village stems (Gandhi versus Ambedkar on the village) are routed to Caste Discrimination; gender-as-capability and empowerment stems to Gender Discrimination; abstract justice, equality and liberty framing to Social and Political Ideals; ideology-label stems (Marxism, socialism as doctrines) to Political Ideologies; universal-dignity and cultural-plurality stems to Humanism, Secularism and Multiculturalism; and environmental policy, targets, data and named projects to the Environment and Governance areas. Only the six development-concept, human/social development, capability, technology-and-ethics, skill-education, Gandhian-development and tribal-reconciliation parts above are counted here.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2019 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Does technological development lead to progress in the ethical standards of the society? Explain.

Model solution

Directive: *Explain* - expound the relation, distinguishing carefully, and reach a reasoned position (not a mere list).

Thesis. Technological development expands human *power and capacity*; it does not, on its own, raise the *ethical standards* of society. It changes the ethical terrain and can serve progress only when governed by defensible ends and institutions.

Distinction that fixes the answer. "Progress in ethical standards" is a **normative** improvement in how people treat one another; technological development is a **factual** increase in capability. Reading the second straight off the first is the fact/value slide: more capacity is not more morality.

The two-sided argument.

- *Apparent yes:* technology reduces drudgery, disease and distance, widening what people can be and do (a capability gain), and can enable moral goods - communication, access, relief.
- *Why that does not settle it:* the same power creates **new ethical problems that did not exist before** - surveillance and loss of privacy, algorithmic manipulation, labour displacement, a digital divide that excludes, and ecological cost. Technology is **not self-justifying**: whether its power becomes progress depends on the *ends* it serves and the *institutions* that govern it.

Objection and reply. *Objection:* historically, technological societies show expanded rights and welfare, so technology and ethical progress rise together. *Reply/residual:* correlation is not authorship - where ethical standards rose, it was through **institutions, movements and reasoning** that directed technological power, not through the technology as such; the same period also produced new, technologically enabled harms.

Graded verdict. Technological development is **ethically ambivalent**: it multiplies power and reshapes the moral landscape, but ethical progress is a separate, value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions. Hence technology can *enable* ethical progress but neither guarantees nor constitutes it.

Why this earns marks: it refuses the one-sided "yes", names the fact/value gap explicitly, gives concrete new-harm categories, handles the correlation objection, and closes with a graded verdict rather than a slogan.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2020 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: State and examine the Gandhian concept of social development.

Model solution

Directive: *State and examine* - first expound the Gandhian concept faithfully, then weigh it with objections and replies and a reasoned verdict.

State - the Gandhian concept of social development. For Gandhi, development is the moral growth of persons and communities, not the volume of production. Its hub is **sarvodaya** - the welfare of all, tested by the condition of the *last and weakest* person. Its supporting commitments are **swaraj** (self-rule as both political freedom and moral self-mastery over wants), **trusteeship** (surplus wealth held in trust for society, not as absolute private right), **restraint of wants** ("enough for need, not for greed"), **dignity of labour** (manual work honoured), and a **decentralised, village-centred** economy using **appropriate technology** scaled to human need. Underlying all is **means-ends unity**: a good end cannot be reached by exploitative means.

Examine - strengths. The model is a powerful critique of consumerist, centralised development: it anticipates **ecological limits** (restraint of throughput), defends **dignity and non-exploitation** as internal to development, and treats people as **moral agents**, not consumers - close, in effect, to a capability-and-sufficiency ethic.

Examine - objections and replies.

- *Scale/romanticisation:* a low-throughput village model may not meet the needs of a large, poor population. *Reply:* the target is insatiable consumerism and centralisation, not health and schooling; "appropriate" scale is revisable without surrendering restraint.

- *Productivity*: restraint may cap the surplus needed to lift millions. *Reply*: the model reframes the *goal* (sufficiency + dignity) rather than maximising output; it is a critique of the metric, not a vow of poverty.
- *Caste and gender (Ambedkar)*: idealising the village can **reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour**. This is the decisive internal-Indian criticism, and it is not fully answered within the Gandhian frame.

Graded verdict. Gandhian social development is a **profound critique of output-centred, centralised modernisation and a partial positive model** - ecologically and morally ahead of its rivals - but it must be **corrected by Ambedkar on caste and gender** and made honest about scale. Its enduring contribution is the metric: development measured by dignity, restraint and the condition of the last person.

Why this earns marks: it "states" the concept completely (all five commitments + means-ends unity), "examines" with a genuine objection/reply set, concedes the Ambedkar critique honestly, and delivers a balanced, non-hagiographic verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2022 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Do you agree that economic development does not on its own lead to human development and social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Model solution

Directive: *Do you agree... Give reasons and justifications* - take a defended position, argue both sides, and justify a graded conclusion.

Thesis. I largely agree: **economic development does not, on its own, lead to human development and social progress**. It is at most a *necessary enabler*; whether it becomes human development and progress depends on **conversion, distribution, agency and ecological limits**.

The ladder that grounds the claim. Distinguish **growth** (more output/income), **development** (structural + human change), and **social progress** (a *justified*, value-level improvement). Economic development sits on the lower rungs; human development (capabilities) and progress (normative) are higher rungs that the lower does not guarantee.

Reasons economic development alone is insufficient.

- *Distribution gap*: aggregate income can rise while inequality, exclusion and displacement rise with it - averages hide who gains.
- *Conversion gap (Sen)*: the same income yields different real freedoms depending on **conversion factors** (disability, gender norms, environment); income is a means, capability is the measure.
- *Recognition*: redistribution of goods can leave **status hierarchies** (caste, gender, disability) intact - progress needs recognition too.
- *Agency and democracy*: development that treats people as beneficiaries but not **agents** misses a constitutive part of a developed life.
- *Ecological limit*: growth that offloads costs onto the future or the poor is not progress (the sustainability/justice frame).

Justification via the necessary/sufficient point. Some material base is plausibly a **necessary enabling condition** for broad capabilities - so economic development is not worthless. But it is **not sufficient**: it must be *converted, distributed and bounded* to count as human development and progress.

Objection and reply. *Objection*: no society achieved broad progress without economic development, so the two go together. *Reply/residual*: that shows economic development is an **enabler**, not that it is the *cause* - the enabling base still has to be converted by just institutions and agency; where it was not, growth coexisted with deprivation.

Graded verdict. Agree, with precision: economic development is a **necessary-enabling but not sufficient** condition; it becomes human development and social progress only through **just conversion into capabilities, recognition, democratic agency and ecological limits**.

Why this earns marks: it takes a clear stance, uses the ladder + capability map + recognition + democracy + ecology as *reasons*, answers the strongest counter (co-occurrence), and lands a qualified, defended verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2023 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: In the present scenario, will the emphasis on skill education enhance development? Evaluate.

Model solution

Directive: *Evaluate* - weigh both sides on stated criteria and reach a graded judgement; do not merely describe skill education.

Thesis. Emphasis on skill education **enhances development conditionally** - when skills expand real capabilities and agency, not merely labour-market employability. As a stand-alone metric, skilling is a *partial* good that can leave people capable yet unfree.

The case for skill education. Skills raise **employability and productivity**, and income can convert (Sen) into further capabilities - health, schooling, security. In a young population, skilling can widen what people are able to do and reduce dependence, which is a genuine developmental gain.

The evaluative limits.

- *Employability is not capability*: training aimed only at market demand can produce **capable workers who remain unfree** - precarious work, no voice, no recognition.
- *Distribution*: if skilling tracks existing advantage, it can **widen** gaps rather than close them.
- *Agency and dignity*: development also requires participation and dignity of labour, which pure skilling does not supply.
- *Quality and match*: skills that do not match real opportunities yield frustration, not freedom.

Objection and reply. *Objection*: in a labour-surplus economy, skilling is the most practical lever of development, so the emphasis is justified. *Reply/residual*: practical value is conceded, but the *emphasis* must be evaluated against the fuller aim - skilling enhances development **only if** it is coupled with capability expansion, decent work and agency; otherwise it enhances output while under-delivering on development.

Graded verdict. Skill education **enhances development when it is capability-directed** - broad, dignified, well-matched and paired with voice and decent work - and under-delivers when reduced to market throughput. The emphasis is justified *conditionally*, not unconditionally.

Why this earns marks: it "evaluates" (two-sided, criterion-based), deploys the employability-vs-capability distinction, answers the practicality objection, and gives a conditional graded verdict rather than a yes/no.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2024 Q3(c), 10+5=15 marks

Question: Is economic development a necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither, in order to achieve social progress? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Model solution

Directive: *necessary condition, sufficient condition, both or neither...* Give reasons and justifications - a precise modal analysis plus a defended verdict (the 10+5 split rewards clean analysis, then judgement).

Thesis. Economic development is, at most, a **necessary enabling condition** for social progress - and **not a sufficient** one. Strictly, it is **neither necessary in every case nor ever sufficient**; the accurate answer is "a necessary-enabler at most, never sufficient."

Fix the modal terms. *Necessary*: progress cannot occur without it. *Sufficient*: its presence guarantees progress. The question forces us to test economic development against both.

Is it necessary? Qualified yes (the material-threshold nuance). Core capabilities - health, education, security - need **some** resource base, so a degree of economic development is plausibly a **necessary enabling condition** for *broad* social progress. *But* limited progress on specific axes (recognition, dignity, participation, legal equality) can be won through **redistribution and reform** without much growth - so economic development is **not strictly necessary in every case**.

Is it sufficient? No. Growth can coexist with **inequality, exclusion, displacement, ecological damage and lost agency**. Averages hide distribution; income must be **converted** (Sen: conversion factors) into real freedoms and

recognised (status justice) to count as progress. Therefore economic development can never, by itself, secure social progress.

Reasons and justification (the 5-mark judgement).

- *Distribution + conversion*: same output, different real freedoms - so presence of growth does not entail progress.
- *Recognition + agency*: material gain leaves status hierarchies and voicelessness untouched unless institutions act.
- *Ecological limit*: growth that steals from the future or the poor is not progress.
- *Counter-case*: reform-driven gains without growth show non-necessity in specific domains.

Graded verdict. Neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient - economic development is best classified as a **necessary-enabling condition at most**, which becomes social progress only through **just conversion into capabilities, recognition, democratic agency and ecological limits**.

Why this earns marks: it defines the modal terms, answers *both* necessity and sufficiency with the material-threshold and counter-case nuance (not a flat "necessary but not sufficient"), justifies with distribution/conversion/recognition/ecology, and closes with the precise "neither... at most enabling" verdict the 10+5 split rewards.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: Is it possible to reconcile the concept of development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive: *Is it possible... Discuss* - argue possibility conditionally, staging both the sceptical and affirmative cases, and specify the conditions.

Thesis. Reconciling development with tribal values to bring social and economic progress is **possible, but only conditionally** - when development shifts from *extraction* to *capability expansion under shared decision-power*, passing four tests. Absent those conditions, "development" is displacement mislabelled.

Frame the conflict. Projects called "development" can impose **displacement, extraction, ecological loss and cultural assimilation** on tribal communities while benefits flow elsewhere. The values at stake are not "backwardness" but **community, ecology, self-governance and a distinct conception of a good life** - so the clash is between two *models* of development, not between development and its absence.

The reconciliation model - four tests.

- **Capability test:** count capabilities *destroyed* (land, forest, community, culture) alongside those *created* (income, schooling) - a net-capability view.
- **Participation test:** tribal communities must share in the **decision**, not merely receive compensation afterwards - agency, not transfer.
- **Irreversibility test:** where loss is permanent (sacred landscape, ecosystem, language), apply a **precautionary presumption against** the project (strong-sustainability logic).
- **Burden test:** costs must not be shifted onto the **least able** while benefits accrue to the advantaged.

Indian legal recognition (facts, not proof). That such reconciliation is institutionally conceivable is shown by **PESA 1996** and the **Forest Rights Act 2006** (statutes recognising Gram Sabha powers and forest rights), *Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest* (**2013**, Gram Sabha consideration in the Niyamgiri context), and **Articles 48A and 51A(g)** (non-justiciable environmental provisions). These are **legal facts** of recognition; they do not by themselves prove the philosophical thesis, but they show the reconciliation is not merely utopian.

Objection and reply. *Objection (both ways):* either tribal values are an obstacle to progress (steamroll), or all development is imposition (romanticise). *Reply/residual:* both are errors - tribal communities also demand capabilities (health, schooling), and genuine consent can license development; the disciplined position denies neither their agency nor their needs, and makes **decision-power**, not compensation, the hinge.

Graded verdict. Reconciliation is **possible if and only if** the four tests are met and consent is real - development as *capability expansion, chosen by the community, within ecological limits*. Then it brings social *and* economic progress

together; otherwise it is extraction renamed.

Why this earns marks: it answers "is it possible" with a conditional thesis, supplies a concrete four-test engine, uses the Indian statutes/judgment/Articles correctly as *facts* (not proof), refuses both romanticising and steamrolling, and specifies the exact conditions in the verdict.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

MCQ 1

Which statement best captures the canonical distinction between economic growth and social progress?

A. Growth is a quantitative rise in output that is at most a possible means, whereas social progress is an evaluative judgement that a change is good and fairly shared. B. Growth and social progress are synonyms, both measured by per-capita income. C. Social progress is descriptive while growth is normative. D. Growth necessarily guarantees social progress once average income rises.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Growth is a quantitative, means-level fact; social progress is a normative, value-level judgement. They are not synonyms, the descriptive/normative labels are reversed in (C), and averages hide distribution so (D) fails.

MCQ 2

The 'economistic model' of development commits which characteristic error?

A. It denies that income has any instrumental value at all. B. A category slide - treating a means (income) and an average (per-head output) as if they were the end (a good life) and its fair distribution. C. It over-emphasises capabilities at the expense of growth. D. It reduces development entirely to ecological limits.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The economistic model slides from means to end and from average to distribution; it does not deny income's instrumental value, nor over-weight capabilities or ecology.

MCQ 3

'Growth can finance development, but only capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits convert material change into social progress.' In the canonical file this master thesis is:

A. A verbatim quotation from Amartya Sen. B. A binding constitutional provision. C. The file's own analytical synthesis (flagged as analysis), to be argued rather than cited as a quotation. D. A Supreme Court holding.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The master thesis is marked analytical synthesis; it must be argued as a reasoned position, not attributed as a quotation, provision or judgment.

MCQ 4

Which sequence correctly orders the three rungs from means to justified end?

A. Progress -> development -> growth. B. Development -> growth -> progress. C. Growth -> progress -> development. D. Growth -> development -> social progress.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The ladder runs growth (means) -> development (structural + human change) -> social progress (justified value); only (D) preserves that order.

MCQ 5

In Sen's capability approach, a 'capability' is best defined as:

A. The real freedom - the set of genuine opportunities - a person has to achieve valuable functionings. B. The bundle of commodities a person owns. C. A subjective feeling of satisfaction. D. An achieved doing or being, such as being nourished.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Capability is real freedom/opportunity; commodities are resources (B), satisfaction is utility (C), and an achieved doing/being is a functioning (D).

MCQ 6

'Conversion factors' in the capability approach explain why:

A. Utility is the correct metric of well-being. B. People with the same resources can have very different real freedoms, because personal, social and environmental factors differ. C. Income always translates one-to-one into functionings. D. Adaptive preferences are irrelevant to well-being.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Conversion factors mean equal resources yield unequal real freedom; they refute the utility metric (A), the one-to-one claim (C) and the dismissal of adaptive preferences (D).

MCQ 7

The phenomenon of 'adaptive preferences' warns that:

A. Capabilities can be read directly off national income. B. Functionings and capabilities are identical. C. The deprived may report contentment because they have adjusted their wants downward, so satisfaction is an unreliable measure of well-being. D. Agency is unimportant in development.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Adaptive preferences make expressed satisfaction unreliable; they do not license reading capability off income (A), equate functioning and capability (B), or downgrade agency (D).

MCQ 8

The Sen-Nussbaum difference is best stated as:

A. Sen rejects capabilities while Nussbaum accepts them. B. Both reduce well-being to utility. C. Nussbaum leaves capabilities entirely to the market. D. Both centre capability, but Sen leaves the list open to public reasoning while Nussbaum defends a threshold list of central capabilities.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Both share the capability core; the split is over specification - Sen's open list via public reasoning versus Nussbaum's threshold list. (A), (B) and (C) misstate both positions.

MCQ 9

The dependency critique primarily argues that:

A. Underdevelopment can be actively produced by unequal relations between centre and periphery, so progress concerns power and terms of trade, not merely internal effort. B. Poor regions are simply 'behind' and must copy rich ones exactly. C. Development is purely a discourse with no material dimension. D. Ecological limits are the only constraint on development.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Dependency stresses centre-periphery power and terms of trade; (B) is the stage-theory it rejects, (C) is post-development over-stated, and (D) is the ecological frame, not dependency.

MCQ 10

A disciplined use of the post-development critique avoids which over-reach?

A. Questioning the neutrality of the vocabulary of 'development'. B. Romanticising poverty and denying that the poor themselves demand health, schooling and capabilities. C. Recognising plural conceptions of a good life. D. Criticising one-size-fits-all development models.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The over-reach to avoid is romanticising deprivation; (A), (C) and (D) are legitimate uses of the critique.

MCQ 11

The distinction between 'weak' and 'strong' sustainability turns on:

A. Whether growth is measured in rupees or in dollars. B. Whether development is urban or rural. C. Whether natural capital is broadly substitutable by man-made capital (weak) or some natural functions are non-substitutable and set hard limits (strong). D. Whether HDI is higher than GDP.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Weak vs strong sustainability is exactly the substitutability of natural capital; the other options are irrelevant contrasts.

MCQ 12

To say that 'development versus environment' is a false dichotomy means:

A. The environment should always be sacrificed for development. B. Development should always be halted to protect the environment. C. Environment and development are wholly unrelated. D. The real question is which development, distributed how, and within which limits - not development or environment as an either/or.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The false-dichotomy point reframes the question as which/how/within-what-limits; (A), (B) and (C) each keep or misread the either/or.

MCQ 13

To call a change 'social progress' rather than mere 'change' is to:

A. Add a value judgement that the change is good on some stated, defended criterion. B. Simply record that the change occurred. C. Measure only the rise in output. D. Assert that the change was historically inevitable.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Progress is a criterion-relative value claim that must be defended; it is not a bare record (B), an output measure (C) or a claim of inevitability (D).

MCQ 14

The canonical position on whether social progress is inevitable is that:

A. Progress is a guaranteed linear law of history. B. Progress is real but contingent, plural and reversible - not an automatic law of history. C. Progress never occurs. D. Progress is identical to economic growth.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The file affirms progress as genuine yet contingent and reversible, rejecting both the linear-law view (A) and the denial of progress (C), and the growth-equation (D).

MCQ 15

Which trio names the sceptical replies to the idea of inevitable, linear progress?

A. Utilitarian, liberal, socialist. B. Weak, strong, neutral. C. Cyclical/tragic, pluralist, and postcolonial critiques. D. Anthropocentric, biocentric, ecocentric.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The replies to inevitability are cyclical/tragic, pluralist and postcolonial; the other trios belong to different debates (ideologies, sustainability, moral standing).

MCQ 16

The postcolonial objection to 'universal progress' warns that:

A. Progress can never be multidimensional. B. Values never conflict. C. Technology always improves ethics. D. A single 'universal' path has often encoded one culture's trajectory as the yardstick, delegitimising others.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The postcolonial point is that a supposedly universal path universalises one culture's trajectory; (A), (B) and (C) are unrelated or false.

MCQ 17

That the criteria of social progress are 'plural and sometimes conflicting' implies:

A. Gains on one value (e.g., liberty) can coincide with losses on another (e.g., equality), so progress is rarely one-dimensional and must be argued across axes. B. Only one criterion - income - ultimately matters. C. The criteria never conflict with one another. D. Progress is a single guaranteed ranking for every society.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Plural, conflicting criteria make progress multidimensional and argued; (B), (C) and (D) each deny the plurality or the conflict.

MCQ 18

The distinction between redistribution and recognition holds that:

A. Recognition alone, without resources, always suffices for justice. B. Injustice concerns both the distribution of goods and status/identity, so pure redistribution can leave status hierarchies (caste, gender, disability) intact. C. Redistribution and recognition are identical. D. Only redistribution matters for social progress.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Justice needs both goods (redistribution) and status (recognition); (A) over-weights recognition, (C) conflates them, and (D) drops recognition.

MCQ 19

Describing democratic participation as 'constitutive' of development means:

A. It is merely a useful instrument for reaching better decisions. B. It is irrelevant to development. C. Being able to take part is itself part of a developed life (agency), not only a means to other goods. D. It guarantees economic growth.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Constitutive means participation is itself part of development (agency); (A) captures only its instrumental role, and (B) and (D) are false.

MCQ 20

On the 2024 necessary/sufficient question, the examiner-grade verdict is that economic development is:

A. Both necessary and sufficient for social progress. B. Sufficient but not necessary. C. Strictly necessary in every case. D. At most a necessary enabler and never sufficient - strictly neither necessary in every case nor ever sufficient.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The material-threshold nuance yields 'necessary-enabler at most, never sufficient', which is neither strictly necessary in every case nor ever sufficient; (A), (B) and (C) misstate the modal analysis.

MCQ 21

The disciplined answer to 'does technological development raise the ethical standards of society?' is:

A. Not on its own - technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions. B. Yes automatically, because capacity and morality are the same thing. C. No, because technology has no ethical relevance whatsoever. D. Yes, because greater output is the same as greater goodness.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Technology changes the ethical terrain without raising standards on its own; (B) conflates capacity with morality, (C) denies all relevance, and (D) equates output with goodness.

MCQ 22

Calling technology 'not self-justifying' means:

A. Technology should never be used at all. B. Whether new power counts as progress depends on the ends it serves and the institutions that govern it, not on the technology itself. C. Technology automatically justifies any outcome it produces. D. Technology is identical to ethical progress.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Not self-justifying means ends and institutions decide whether power becomes progress; (A) is Luddism, and (C) and (D) are exactly the errors the phrase denies.

MCQ 23

The strongest evaluative limit on the claim 'skill education enhances development' is that:

A. Skills never raise employability. B. Skills are identical to capabilities. C. Employability is not the same as capability - market-directed skilling can produce capable workers who remain unfree (precarious, voiceless, unrecognised). D. Development requires no material base whatsoever.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The limit is that employability is not capability; (A) and (B) are false, and (D) contradicts the material-threshold point.

MCQ 24

An 'Evaluate' verdict on skill education (2023) should conclude that it:

A. Never enhances development under any conditions. B. Always and unconditionally enhances development. C. Is wholly irrelevant to development. D. Enhances development conditionally - when it expands genuine capabilities and agency, not mere labour-market throughput.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The graded verdict is conditional enhancement; (A), (B) and (C) are the one-sided answers 'Evaluate' is designed to exclude.

MCQ 25

In Gandhian thought, 'trusteeship' means that:

A. The wealthy hold their surplus in trust for society rather than as an absolute private right. B. The state nationalises all private property by force. C. Wealth should be accumulated without any limit. D. Manual labour is degrading and should be avoided.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Trusteeship treats surplus wealth as held in trust for society; (B) is state seizure, (C) is unlimited accumulation, and (D) contradicts dignity of labour.

MCQ 26

'Sarvodaya' is best rendered as:

A. Rule by a technical elite. B. The welfare and uplift of all, tested by the condition of the last and weakest person. C. The maximisation of aggregate national output. D. The pursuit of unlimited wants.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Sarvodaya is the uplift of all, measured by the last person's condition; the other options describe technocracy, output-maximisation and consumerism, all of which Gandhi rejects.

MCQ 27

The decisive internal-Indian objection to the Gandhian village model is that:

A. It over-industrialises society. B. It ignores ecological limits. C. Idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour (the Ambedkar objection). D. It abandons the idea of the dignity of labour.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Ambedkar's objection is that the idealised village reproduces caste and gender hierarchy; (A) and (B) misdescribe the model, and (D) contradicts a core Gandhian commitment.

MCQ 28

Gandhian 'means-ends unity' asserts that:

A. Any means is acceptable provided the end is good. B. Ends and means are wholly unrelated. C. Only the ends matter in politics and economics. D. A good end cannot be achieved through exploitative or violent means; the means shape the end.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Means-ends unity holds that means shape ends, so good ends need good means; (A), (B) and (C) each sever that link.

MCQ 29

In the reconciliation model, the 'participation test' requires that tribal communities:

A. Share in the decision itself, not merely receive compensation after it is taken. B. Are compensated generously in cash after displacement. C. Are excluded from planning in the name of efficiency. D. Abandon their distinct conception of a good life.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Participation means a share in the decision, not post-hoc compensation (B); (C) and (D) are exactly what the model rules out.

MCQ 30

PESA 1996 and the Forest Rights Act 2006 should be used in a philosophy answer as:

A. Proof that the philosophical thesis about tribal values is true. B. Dated legal facts of institutional recognition (Gram Sabha powers; forest rights) that illustrate, but do not by themselves prove, the argument. C. Non-binding moral opinions with no legal status. D. Supreme Court judgments.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: They are enacted statutes used as legal facts of recognition, not as philosophical proof (A), not opinions without status (C), and not judgments (D).

MCQ 31

The 'irreversibility test' in the reconciliation model implies that:

A. All development should proceed regardless of permanent loss. B. Compensation can always offset any loss whatsoever. C. Where loss is permanent (a sacred landscape, an ecosystem, a language), a precautionary presumption operates against the project. D. Reversible and irreversible losses are to be treated identically.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Irreversibility triggers a precautionary presumption against the project; (A), (B) and (D) all ignore the special weight of permanent loss.

MCQ 32

Orissa Mining Corporation v. Ministry of Environment & Forest (2013) is correctly described as:

A. A statute enacted by Parliament. B. A non-justiciable Directive Principle of State Policy. C. A fabricated illustration with no legal status. D. A Supreme Court judgment in which Gram Sabha consideration featured in the Niyamgiri context.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: It is a Supreme Court judgment; it is not a statute (A), not a Directive Principle (B), and it is a real, correctly classified legal fact (not C).

MCQ 33

Arne Naess's (1973) distinction between 'shallow' and 'deep' ecology contrasts:

A. Reforming pollution to protect human interests (shallow) with rethinking the human-nature relationship itself (deep). B. Weak versus strong sustainability. C. Redistribution versus recognition. D. Necessary versus sufficient conditions.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Shallow ecology reforms for human interests; deep ecology rethinks the relationship. The other pairs belong to different debates.

MCQ 34

The 'non-identity problem' in intergenerational justice observes that:

A. Future generations have no moral status at all. B. Because present choices determine which future people exist, it is puzzling to say we 'harm' specific future individuals - which motivates impersonal duties and precaution instead. C. We can never affect the future in any way. D. Natural capital is always fully substitutable.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The non-identity problem shifts the ground from person-affecting harm to impersonal duties and precaution; (A), (C) and (D) misstate the problem and its context.

MCQ 35

Why is a blanket 'degrowth' prescription treated as asymmetric for a country like India?

A. Because degrowth has no ecological rationale. B. Because productivism is always the correct policy. C. Because a country with large unmet basic needs requires capability expansion at the base, so the disciplined position couples sufficiency at the top with base-level capability under ecological limits. D. Because ecological limits do not apply to India.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The asymmetry is that base-level capability expansion is still needed, so sufficiency-at-top is coupled with capability-at-base; (A), (B) and (D) are all false.

MCQ 36

The 'environmentalism of the poor' (Guha and Martinez-Alier, 1997) foregrounds:

A. The claim that only the wealthy genuinely care about nature. B. That ecological concern is purely aesthetic. C. That environmental protection always conflicts with justice. D. Distributive ecological conflict - who bears the environmental costs of development now - linking ecology to justice for the poor.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: It centres distributive ecological conflict and the poor who bear present costs; (A), (B) and (C) invert or trivialise the idea.

MCQ 37

The 'growth model vs Sen' debate is best summarised as a dispute over:

A. The metric of development - income/output versus capability/real freedom - with Sen winning on what development is for and growth retained as an enabler. B. Whether ecology matters to development. C. Whether the village reproduces caste. D. Whether technology is self-justifying.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Growth-vs-Sen is a metric war (income vs capability); the other options name different debates in the clause.

MCQ 38

In the model matrix, the 'key danger' of the human-development / capability model is:

A. The category slide of treating income as the end. B. Index-worship and the difficulty of measuring capabilities. C. Eco-authoritarianism. D. Reproducing caste hierarchy.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The capability model's characteristic danger is index-worship/measurement difficulty; the category slide is the economistic model's danger (A), eco-authoritarianism the ecological model's (C), and caste-reproduction the Gandhian village critique (D).

MCQ 39

Which of the following is a canonical 'common trap' the clause warns against?

A. Carefully distinguishing growth, development and progress. B. Naming the value criterion in a progress claim. C. Citing statutes such as PESA or the Forest Rights Act as if they were philosophical proof of a thesis. D. Applying the four tribal-reconciliation tests.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Treating statutes as philosophical proof is a listed trap; (A), (B) and (D) are exactly the good practices the clause recommends.

MCQ 40

The recommended 'final answer spine' for any development stem runs:

A. Thesis -> conclusion, skipping objections entirely. B. Verdict first, followed by unrelated facts. C. A chronological list of dates with no argument. D. Directive -> thesis -> ladder/capability -> model contrast -> limit + justice -> objection/reply -> graded verdict.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The universal spine is the full directive-to-verdict architecture in (D); (A), (B) and (C) omit the reasoning that earns marks.

Remedial MCQ 41

A candidate writes: 'GDP rose, therefore society progressed.' The core error is:

A. Conflating growth (a quantitative means) with social progress (a defended value claim), ignoring distribution, agency and ecological cost. B. Correctly identifying the necessary and sufficient conditions of progress. C. Over-applying the capability approach. D. Romanticising the village economy.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The error is the growth-equals-progress slide, which ignores distribution, agency and ecological cost; the other options misdescribe the mistake.

Remedial MCQ 42

A candidate defines Sen's 'capability' as 'income plus welfare schemes.' The correction is:

A. Capability is simply the same as utility. B. Capability is the real freedom to achieve valuable functionings; income and schemes are resources whose value depends on conversion into that freedom. C. Capability is a bundle of commodities. D. Capability is an achieved functioning such as being nourished.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Capability is real freedom, not resources (income/schemes/commodities) and not utility (A) or an achieved functioning (D).

Remedial MCQ 43

A candidate treats HDI as a complete measure of social progress. The correction is:

A. HDI already captures every dimension of progress. B. HDI is a fabricated index with no basis. C. HDI is a useful but partial proxy - indicators embody values and aggregate averages hide distribution, so measurement is not the same as progress. D. HDI measures only ecological limits.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: HDI is a partial proxy: averages hide distribution and measurement is not progress; (A) over-claims, (B) is false, and (D) misdescribes it.

Remedial MCQ 44

A candidate answers the 2019 stem with 'technology automatically raises ethical standards.' The correction is:

A. Technology has no relation to ethics at all. B. Capacity and morality are simply identical. C. Ethical standards necessarily fall whenever technology advances. D. Technology expands power and reshapes the ethical terrain, but ethical progress is a separate value-level achievement secured by ends and institutions.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Technology changes the terrain without raising standards on its own; (A), (B) and (C) are each one-sided errors the disciplined answer avoids.

Remedial MCQ 45

A candidate praises Gandhi's model of development without mentioning its decisive Indian objection. The missing point is:

A. The Ambedkar objection - idealising the village can reproduce caste hierarchy and gendered labour. B. That Gandhi ignored ecological limits. C. That Gandhi sought to maximise aggregate output. D. That trusteeship means state seizure of property.

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The decisive missing objection is Ambedkar's caste-and-gender critique of the idealised village; (B), (C) and (D) misdescribe Gandhi's position.

Remedial MCQ 46

A candidate answers the 2024 stem with a flat 'necessary but not sufficient' and stops. The refinement that earns the 5-mark judgement split is:

A. That economic development is in fact sufficient after all. B. The material-threshold / both-neither nuance: a necessary enabler for broad progress, yet not strictly necessary in every case (limited gains via redistribution and recognition) and never sufficient. C. That economic development is wholly irrelevant to progress. D. That 'necessary' and 'sufficient' mean the same thing.

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The 5-mark refinement is the both-neither nuance beyond the flat formula; (A), (C) and (D) are analytic errors.

Remedial MCQ 47

A candidate concludes that reconciling development with tribal values is impossible because all development is imposition. The correction is:

A. Tribal communities never demand capabilities such as health or schooling. B. Compensation alone fully reconciles development with tribal values. C. This romanticises deprivation and denies tribal agency; reconciliation is possible when development shifts to shared decision-power and passes the capability, participation, irreversibility and burden tests. D. Statutes such as PESA prove that reconciliation is automatic.

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The correction rejects both romanticising and steamrolling and specifies the four tests plus shared decision-power; (A), (B) and (D) are each mistaken.

Remedial MCQ 48

A candidate cites Articles 48A and 51A(g) as enforceable guarantees that prove an environmental duty. The correction is:

A. They are Supreme Court judgments. B. They are enacted statutes like PESA and the Forest Rights Act. C. They are fabricated provisions with no textual basis. D. They are non-justiciable constitutional provisions - a Directive Principle and a Fundamental Duty - which are dated legal facts, not enforceable guarantees or philosophical proof.

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Articles 48A and 51A(g) are non-justiciable provisions used as dated facts, not enforceable guarantees or proof; they are not judgments (A), statutes (B) or fabricated (C).

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

Original Mains 1

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 10 marks | ~150 words | directive: Distinguish + Explain.

Question: Distinguish between economic growth, development and social progress, and explain why the distinction matters for policy. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The three are distinct levels - a quantitative means, a structural change, and a defended value - and collapsing them distorts policy.

Distinctions.

- **Economic growth:** a rise in aggregate output/income; a *possible means*, silent on distribution and cost.
- **Development:** structural and human change - capabilities, health, education, institutions; descriptive but richer than output.
- **Social progress:** an *evaluative* judgement that a change is good and fairly shared, made on a stated criterion (freedom, justice, dignity, sustainability).

Why it matters for policy. If growth is mistaken for progress (the economistic category slide), policy targets averages while inequality, displacement and ecological cost worsen. Keeping the rungs separate forces policy to ask not only 'how much more?' but 'converted into whose capabilities, under what justice and within what limits?'

Verdict. Growth can *finance* development, but only capabilities, justice, participation and ecological limits convert material change into social progress.

Why this earns marks: three clean definitions, the category-slide point, and a policy pay-off with a crisp verdict.

Original Mains 2

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 15 marks | ~220 words | directive: Examine.

Question: The capability approach shifts the question of development from 'how many resources does a person command?' to 'what is a person actually able to be and to do?'. Examine this shift and its limits. Answer in about 220 words.

Model solution

Thesis. The capability shift is the decisive advance in development theory, but its measurement burden and specification dispute mark its limits.

The shift. Sen replaces resources and utility with **real freedom**. A *functioning* is an achieved being/doing; a *capability* is the freedom to achieve functionings; *agency* is being the author of one's ends. **Conversion factors** explain why equal resources yield unequal freedom (disability, gender norms, environment), and **adaptive preferences** show that expressed satisfaction can mask deprivation. Mahbub ul Haq and the UNDP framework translate this into human development.

What it buys. It reclassifies the field: resources are means, utility is an unreliable mental state, achieved functionings are outcomes, capabilities are real opportunities. Development becomes the expansion of what people can be and do, with people as agents, not mere beneficiaries.

Limits.

- *Measurement*: capabilities are harder to quantify than income, so indices (HDI) are useful but partial proxies - never mistake the index for the thing.
- *Specification (Sen vs Nussbaum)*: Sen leaves the list open to public reasoning (pluralism, but underspecification); Nussbaum defends a threshold list (sharper, but risks paternalism).

Verdict. The shift is correct and largely settled; the open questions are *how to measure* and *how far to specify* capabilities - not whether to make the shift.

Why this earns marks: it examines both the gain and the two genuine limits, names the internal debate precisely, and reaches a qualified verdict.

Original Mains 3

Original question (not a PYQ) - Philosophy Paper II, Socio-Political Philosophy | 20 marks | ~300 words | directive: Critically examine + Assess.

Question: Critically examine the view that development is legitimate only within ecological limits and intergenerational justice, and assess whether a 'degrowth' prescription is appropriate for a country with large unmet basic needs. Answer in about 300 words.

Model solution

Thesis. Bounding development by ecological limits and intergenerational justice is defensible; a *blanket* degrowth prescription is not appropriate for a society with large unmet basic needs, which requires capability expansion at the base coupled with sufficiency at the top.

The case for limits. The sustainability/justice triangle has three corners: **ecological limit** (finite throughput; under *strong* sustainability some natural functions are non-substitutable), **intergenerational justice** (duties to future people), and **distributive justice now** (the environmentalism of the poor - who bears ecological costs today). The **non-identity problem** shows our choices determine which future people exist, so obligation shifts from person-affecting harm to **impersonal duties and precaution**. Naess's (1973) deep ecology and the anthropocentric/biocentric/ecocentric spectrum widen moral standing. The 'development versus environment' framing is a **false dichotomy**: the real question is which development, distributed how, within what limits.

Assessing degrowth. Degrowth rightly attacks **productivism** (output as the goal). But applied wholesale to a country with large unmet needs, it is **asymmetric**: it would cap the base-level capability expansion (health, schooling, security) that the poor legitimately demand. The disciplined position couples **sufficiency at the top** (restraint of luxury throughput) with **capability expansion at the base**, all under ecological limits.

Objection and reply. *Objection*: ecological emergency justifies suspending growth and even democracy (eco-authoritarianism). *Reply/residual*: this trades away agency, a constitutive part of development; the answer is a **just transition** - limits met *with* participation and distributive fairness, protecting the vulnerable.

Verdict. Development ought to be bounded by ecological limits and intergenerational justice; but the instrument is a *just transition with base-level capability expansion*, not blanket degrowth. (Articles 48A and 51A(g) are non-justiciable facts of constitutional concern, not proof of any thesis.)

Why this earns marks: it critically examines the limits thesis, assesses degrowth with the India-specific asymmetry, answers the eco-authoritarian objection, and closes with a calibrated verdict and correct legal-status discipline.